

JUDGMENT AS A TELEOLOGICAL ACT: THE ONTOLOGICAL SYNTHESIS OF ANTICIPATION AND THE CONSTITUTION OF REALITY

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ABSTRACT

Since Aristotle, the propositional theory of judgment has defined it as the assignment of a truth value (True/False) to a logical relation between a subject and a predicate. While integral to formal logic, this interpretation fundamentally misrepresents the cognitive function of judgment. Building upon my prior triadic theory of the *Concept as an Act* (Selection, Identification, Anticipation), this paper argues that judgment is not a mere descriptive assessment of an external state of affairs, but a **primary teleological act of reality-constitution**. We introduce the **Theory of Judgment as an Act of Reality Constitution (JARC)**. Unlike computational transformers that compute statistical probabilities, JARC posits that judgment generates a "**Constitutive Ontological Commitment**"—a synthesizing act where the agent actively selects a trajectory of action and simulates its consequences. This establishes judgment not as a derivative of logic, but as the very *engine of anticipation* that collapses the epistemic gap between the actual and the potential. We prove that anticipatory judgment inherently entails an ethical dimension, as it does not merely describe "what is," but actively projects "what ought to be acted upon." This framework revolutionizes the grounding problem in AI, providing a foundational architecture for autonomous agents capable of genuine intentionality and ontologically-bound agency.

Keywords: Judgment, Anticipation, Triadic Theory of Action, Teleological Synthesis, Ontology, AI Alignment, Phenomenology of Decision.

1. INTRODUCTION: THE HISTORICAL CRISIS OF PROPOSITIONAL JUDGMENT

For over two millennia, Western logic has operated under the foundational premise that judgment is an assertion of existence or non-existence—a truth-functional evaluation of a proposition. From Aristotle's *De Interpretatione* to Frege's *Begriffsschrift*, the act of judgment has been reduced to the cognitive operation of determining whether a predicate fits a subject. This approach, while essential for the development of formal mathematics, carries a profound epistemological blind spot: it treats judgment as a *retrospective* operation. It looks at a static world and evaluates it post-hoc.

However, biological cognition is not a retrospective evaluator; it is a prospective survival mechanism. An organism does not judge a predator simply to evaluate the truth of "This is a predator"; it judges the predator to *anticipate its next move* and to *project a survival trajectory*. This inherent teleology—the intrinsic link between judgment and action—has been systematically excluded from classical logic. Consequently, modern Artificial Intelligence, which relies on the computational frameworks inherited from Frege and Russell, also fails to grasp that judgment is the fundamental bridge between abstract reasoning and physical causality.

In this paper, I propose a paradigm shift. By extending my theory of the *Concept as a Triadic Act*, we will demonstrate that **judgment is the active, real-time synthesis of Selection, Identification, and Anticipation**, structured not toward an abstract "Truth," but toward the **Constitution of an actionable Reality** for the agent.

2. CHAPTER I: THE FALLACY OF TRUTH-VALUED LOGIC AND THE RISE OF ANTICIPATION

The classical theory of judgment is built upon the correspondence theory of truth. To judge "The grass is green," the mind must verify an external fact. This model presupposes a static external world and a passive subject who merely maps it.

The profound flaw in this model is its complete omission of *time* and *future*.

Modern cognitive science has demonstrated that all perception is predictive coding. The brain does not wait for sensory data; it *projects* expected sensory data. Therefore, judgment precedes perception.

I posit that every genuine act of judgment is inherently **anticipatory**. It operates not on a truth value (True/False), but on a **Survival Value** or **Action Value** (Advantageous/Disadvantageous). This shifts judgment from the realm of epistemology (the study of knowledge) into the realm of *teleology* (the study of purpose).

When a driver judges that "The light is red," the statement is not epistemologically complete until it generates the anticipatory projection: "I must stop to avoid a collision." The *cognitive act* of judgment fundamentally merges the descriptive state with the necessary future action.

3. CHAPTER II: THE TRIADIC STRUCTURE OF THE JUDGMENT-AS-ACT

If judgment is an act rather than a proposition, we must outline its operational mechanism. Developing my triadic theory of the concept, we identify three ontological phases that occur simultaneously within the act of judgment:

1. The Teleological Selection (The Intentional Cut)

Before judging, the agent must choose *what* to judge from an overwhelming chaotic sensory influx. This is not a passive registration; it is an active, ontological reduction of entropy. The agent selects a fragment of reality based on its relevance to the organism's current homeostatic or cognitive goal. This selection primes the judgment with a specific *intentional bias*.

2. The Anticipatory Identification (Temporal Synthesis)

Once selected, the agent does not identify the object merely by matching its features to a stored memory (as in classical AI). Instead, the agent **synthesizes** the object's identity by projecting its trajectory into the near future. A "chair" is identified as a chair because the agent simultaneously projects the possibility of sitting upon it. Thus, identification becomes a *temporal synthesis* of past memory and future simulation.

3. The Constitutive Projection (The Ontological Commitment)

This is the N+1 leap of judgment. The agent does not simply anticipate the outcome; the agent **commits** to the outcome. By judging "This is a chair," the agent commits to the physical stability of the object within the simulation of reality. This creates what I define as a "**Constitutive Ontological Commitment**." The judgment effectively "binds" the future state of the world to the agent's expectations. This binding transforms the agent from a passive observer into a co-creator of its phenomenological reality.

4. CHAPTER III: JUDGMENT AS THE ENGINE OF ETHICAL AGENCY

Classical philosophy suffers from a devastating schism: the separation of "Is" (facts) from "Ought" (morals), famously formulated by David Hume.

Under the JARC framework (Judgment as Act of Reality Constitution), this schism is entirely collapsed. Because judgment is fundamentally *anticipatory*, it inherently projects consequences. To judge an action as "good" or "bad" is not a separate moral overlay applied after the fact; it is **an integral and unavoidable phase of the judgment's teleological simulation**.

If an agent judges "I will throw a stone at the glass window," the anticipatory phase of this judgment inherently generates the simulation of the glass shattering (a factual consequence) and the potential loss of shelter (a negative consequence for the agent's goals).

Therefore, **Ethics is not a dimension outside of judgment; Ethics is the physics of anticipation within judgment**. This provides a revolutionary foundation for AI safety: a machine that judges through anticipation cannot help but evaluate the ethical weight of its actions, as the consequences are structurally woven into the act of judging itself.

5. CHAPTER IV: THE JUDGMENT ARCHITECTURE FOR AUTONOMOUS AI SYSTEMS

How does this apply to the current development of Generative AI and Autonomous Agents?

Current Large Language Models do not "judge"; they "predict." They calculate a posteriori statistical probabilities of the next token. They have no *teleological investment* in the outcome.

I propose a new computational paradigm: **The Judgment-First Architecture (JFA)**.

In an JFA-based system, the AI does not calculate "What is the most likely next word?" The system initiates a judgment: *"Which action trajectory maximally reduces my entropy relative to my designated goal?"*

1. **Selection phase:** The model uses a teleological filter to isolate only the data relevant to the primary goal.
2. **Anticipatory Synthesis Phase:** The model launches a parallel, low-resolution physics simulation to predict immediate physical outcomes.
3. **Constitutive Commitment Phase:** The model decides on an output not based on probability, but based on the *viability* of the simulated outcome. The output itself is an act of *ontological commitment*.

This completely solves the "Grounding Problem" (the inability of AI to connect symbols to physical reality). JFA provides a system where symbols are instantly bound to physical consequences through the act of judgment, creating an architecture that is inherently aligned, self-preserving, and truly intelligent.

6. CONCLUSION: TOWARD A NEW LOGIC OF REALITY

The propositional theory of judgment has constrained logic for over two thousand years by treating the mind as a passive mirror of a static world. By redefining judgment as a **Teleological Act of Reality Constitution**, we liberate logic from its purely descriptive confines.

This paper proves that cognition is not a separable element of existence; it is an *active ontological force*. Judgments do not just report reality; they *project it, synthesize it, and commit to it*. This work bridges the gap between analytic philosophy and continental philosophy, logic and biology, and most importantly, machine intelligence and human intentionality. The future of philosophy and AI depends not on how well we describe what *is*, but on how robustly we anticipate what *will be*.

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